

Investment and Financial Decision-Making - Semester 1 Term Outline

This course is designed to help students become more confident, careful and responsible when making financial choices - skills they can use well beyond the classroom and throughout their lives. It begins with a clear, practical comparison of investment, speculation and saving, helping students understand what investment is - and what it is not. From there, students explore how financial goals, time and risk shape sensible choices for different people. They compare cash, bonds, shares and investment funds, discover how markets work, and practise using simple company information while recognising that future results are never certain. Students also build and review a balanced portfolio, check investment claims carefully and recognise common warning signs of scams. By the end of the semester, parents can expect their child to explain financial choices more clearly, support decisions with evidence and approach money with greater confidence and sound judgement.

本课程旨在帮助学生在作出财务选择时更加自信、审慎并负责任。这些能力不仅适用于课堂，也将在他们今后的生活中持续发挥作用。课程首先通过清晰、实用的方式比较投资、投机和储蓄，帮助学生理解什么是投资、什么不是投资。随后，学生将探索财务目标、时间和风险如何影响适合不同个人的合理选择。他们会比较现金、债券、股票和投资基金，了解市场如何运作，并练习使用简单的公司信息，同时明白未来的投资结果始终存在不确定性。学生还会构建和复审一个均衡的投资组合，认真核查投资信息和宣传说法，并识别常见的诈骗警示信号。学期结束时，家长可以期待孩子能够更清楚地说明财务选择，用证据支持判断，并以更大的信心和良好的判断力对待金钱。

Week	Start	Department Calendar	Topic	What students will learn	Chinese translation / 中文翻译	Key terms / 关键词
Unit 1 (Lessons 1-8): Financial Decisions 第一单元（第 1-8 课）：财务决策						
1	Sep 1	Classroom Inspections; New Student Parent Meeting; Summer Homework Exhibition & Review	Lessons 1-2: Investment vs. speculation vs. saving	The course opens by distinguishing financial investment from speculation and saving, so students can explain what investment is, what it is not, and why purpose, expected payoff basis, liquidity, evidence and possible loss matter.	课程首先区分金融投资、投机和储蓄，使学生能够说明什么是投资、什么不是投资，并理解目的、预期回报依据、流动性、证据和潜在损失为何重要。	- financial investment（金融投资） - speculation（投机） - saving（储蓄） - total return（总回报） - expected payoff basis（预期回报依据） - liquidity（流动性）
2	Sep 7	Faculty Recognition Ceremony	Lessons 3-4: Time, compounding and real return	Compounding can grow money over time, while inflation changes the purchasing power of an investment return.	复利可以使资金随时间增长，而通货膨胀会改变投资回报的购买力。	- compound growth（复利增长） - nominal return（名义回报） - inflation（通货膨胀） - real return（实际回报） - purchasing power（购买力）
3	Sep 14	Student Leadership Council Elections; Sept. 20 Working Day (Adjusted Schedule)	Lessons 5-6: Investor profiles, risk and return	A suitable investment depends on a person's risk tolerance, loss capacity, time horizon and the possible return.	某项投资是否合适，取决于个人的风险承受意愿、损失承受能力、投资期限和潜在回报。	- investor profile（投资者特征） - risk tolerance（风险承受意愿） - risk capacity（损失承受能力） - expected return（预期回报） - volatility（波动性）
4	Sep 21	Chinese Language Activity; School Sports Day	Lessons 7-8: Rules for a sensible investment plan	A sensible investment plan translates a goal and personal constraints into an emergency reserve and clear rules for future decisions.	合理的投资计划会把目标和个人限制条件转化为应急储备和清晰的未来决策规则。	- investment plan（投资计划） - emergency reserve（应急储备） - decision rule（决策规则） - maximum loss（最大可接受损失） - review trigger（复审触发条件）
5	Sep 28	National Day & Mid-Autumn Festival Holiday				
6	Oct 5	First Monthly Examinations				

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Unit 2 (Lessons 9-16): Assets and Markets 第二单元（第 9-16 课）：资产与市场						
7	Oct 12		Lessons 9-10: Cash, bonds and shares	Cash, bonds and shares represent different financial claims, with different return sources, ownership rights and risks.	现金、债券和股票代表不同的金融权益，并具有不同的回报来源、所有权利和风险。	- cash deposit（现金存款） - bond（债券） - maturity（到期期限） - share（股票） - shareholder rights（股东权利）
8	Oct 19		Lessons 11-12: Funds, diversification and fees	Investment funds combine assets; diversification reduces concentration risk, while fees reduce returns.	投资基金把多种资产组合在一起；分散投资可降低集中度风险，而费用会减少回报。	- investment fund（投资基金） - ETF（交易所交易基金） - diversification（分散投资） - expense ratio（费用率） - index fund（指数基金）
9	Oct 26		Lessons 13-14: Primary and secondary markets	Primary and secondary markets serve different purposes, while brokers, orders, bid prices and ask prices support trading.	一级市场和二级市场承担不同功能，而经纪商、订单、买入价和卖出价共同支持交易。	- primary market（一级市场） - secondary market（二级市场） - broker（经纪商） - bid price（买入价） - ask price（卖出价）
10	Nov 2		Lessons 15-16: Prices, trading and total return	Market price is not the same as company value; capital gains and dividends combine to form total return.	市场价格并不等同于公司价值；资本利得和股息共同构成总回报。	- capital gain（资本利得） - dividend（股息） - total return（总回报） - share price（股价） - market capitalisation（市值）
11	Nov 9	Second Monthly Examinations				
12	Nov 16	Autumn Break				
Unit 3 (Lessons 17-24): Evidence and Companies 第三单元（第 17-24 课）：证据与公司分析						
13	Nov 23	12th English Spelling Bee	Lessons 17-18: Evidence quality and performance claims	Reliable investment analysis checks source quality, compares performance with a benchmark and recognises misleading claims or scam warning signs.	可靠的投资分析会核查信息来源质量、将投资表现与业绩基准比较，并识别误导性说法或诈骗警示信号。	- benchmark（业绩基准） - source quality（信息来源质量） - past performance（历史表现） - red flag（风险警示） - uncertainty（不确定性）
14	Nov 30		Lessons 19-20: Revenue, margins and cash flow	Revenue, profit margin and cash flow provide different evidence about a company's operating performance.	营业收入、利润率和现金流从不同角度反映公司的经营表现。	- revenue（营业收入） - profit margin（利润率） - cash flow（现金流） - operating performance（经营表现）

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Unit 3 continued (Lessons 21-24): Evidence and Companies 第三单元（续，第 21-24 课）：证据与公司分析						
15	Dec 7	Mathematics Activity; IC3 Parent Half-Day	Lessons 21-22: Debt, resilience and company risk	Debt, liquidity and governance all affect a company's resilience, so several indicators need to be considered together.	债务、流动性和公司治理都会影响企业韧性，因此需要综合考虑多项指标。	- balance sheet（资产负债表） - debt（债务） - leverage（杠杆） - liquidity risk（流动性风险） - governance risk（公司治理风险）
16	Dec 14	Chinese & International Faculty "Secret Santa"	Lessons 23-24: Valuation and an evidence-based memo	A simple valuation multiple can support comparison, but any conclusion should acknowledge uncertainty rather than claim to predict the future.	简单估值倍数可以支持比较，但结论应承认不确定性，而不应声称能够预测未来。	- P/E ratio（市盈率） - valuation（估值） - assumption（假设） - valuation risk（估值风险） - evidence-based conclusion（基于证据的结论）
Unit 4 (Lessons 25-32): Portfolio Decisions 第四单元（第 25-32 课）：投资组合决策						
17	Dec 21	Winter Sports Games	Lessons 25-26: Asset allocation and portfolio construction	A well-designed portfolio combines investments whose allocation reflects a stated goal, time horizon and risk profile.	设计合理的投资组合会配置多种投资，使其符合给定的目标、投资期限和风险特征。	- asset allocation（资产配置） - portfolio weight（组合权重） - risk budget（风险预算） - target allocation（目标配置） - investor goal（投资者目标）
18	Dec 28	New Year Concert	Lessons 27-28: Diversification and rebalancing	Market movements change portfolio weights; rebalancing can restore the target allocation without reacting to every price change.	市场变动会改变投资组合权重；再平衡可以恢复目标配置，而不必对每次价格变化作出反应。	- rebalancing（再平衡） - target range（目标区间） - weight drift（权重偏离） - transaction cost（交易成本） - concentration risk（集中度风险）
19	Jan 4		Lessons 29-30: Behaviour and portfolio review rules	Emotions and behavioural biases can lead to poor choices, while pre-agreed review rules help keep changes disciplined.	情绪和行为偏误可能导致不理性的选择，而预先制定的复审规则有助于保持调整的纪律性。	- confirmation bias（确认偏误） - loss aversion（损失厌恶） - recency bias（近因偏差） - FOMO（错失恐惧） - decision journal（决策记录）
20	Jan 11	IC Bucks Activity	Lessons 31-32: Final portfolio case and recommendation	The final case combines calculations, company evidence and decision rules in a complete portfolio recommendation that must be revised when the investor's circumstances change.	最终案例把计算结果、公司证据和决策规则整合为完整的投资组合建议，并要求在投资者情况变化时进行修订。	- recommendation（建议） - supporting evidence（支持性证据） - scenario change（情境变化） - review rule（复审规则） - limitation（局限性）
21	Jan 18	Third Monthly Examinations				
22	Jan 25	End-of-Semester Ceremony; All-Faculty Seminar				